



Fall

As the days get colder and shorter, the tree stops making food. The chlorophyll that makes the leaves green begins to break down, and they change from green to red and gold and fall from the tree.

Winter

In the cold winter months, the branches are bare and the tree lies dormant, preserving its energy and water until the following spring.

Deciduous or evergreen?



**Deciduous tree
in fall**

*Leaves change
from green to red.*



**Evergreen
tree**

There are two main types of trees. Deciduous trees lose their leaves in winter as they stop growing. In spring, they produce thin leaves that make food efficiently, so the tree grows fast in summer. Evergreen trees have tougher leaves that make food more slowly but stay on the tree all year long.

Trunk rings

The tough outer bark protects the layer of growing plant tissue beneath it.

Wide, pale rings form in spring, while narrow, dark rings form later in the year.

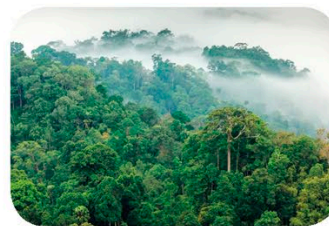
The heartwood at the center is the oldest part of the tree.

**Cross section
of a tree trunk**

Every year, a tree's trunk grows broader as a layer of woody tissue is added beneath the bark. The tissue grows fastest in spring, making softer wood, and more slowly late in the year, making harder wood. This forms annual growth rings, which are revealed if the tree is cut down.

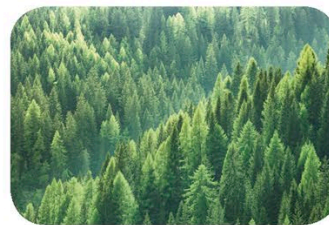
Types of forests

Where there is enough rainfall for trees to grow in large numbers, they can form dense forests. The type of forest depends on the nature of the trees, which is determined by the climate.



Rain forest

In wet climates with no winter frosts, trees grow all year round to create rain forests. These are mostly found around the tropics.



Coniferous

The forests that grow in cold northern climates are mostly made up of tough evergreen conifer trees, such as pines and spruces.



Deciduous

Regions with long summers and short winters have forests of deciduous trees. They lose their leaves in fall but grow new ones in spring.